Wounded

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Summary

Shadow Weaver brightly decided to annoy and provoke the Bright Moon guards that were on shift...

The Provoking resulted in her getting stabbed by one of the guards.

Castaspella ends up taking the woman with her back to Mystacor.

- Inspired by Wounded Shadow Weaver fanart on Tumblr from BlueSky by Diaspro5189 (Xenakis)

Early morning in Bright Moon.

The guards shift was just changing… and Shadow Weaver couldn't sleep in the… *prison*.

With a deep, bored sigh, the old woman looked at the door and approached.

These people were too naïve… How could they be so stupid as to leave her in this huge room without any sealing spells this time!?

Well, she wasn't exactly going to *ask* to be further restricted…

However, she would totally make use of this freedom to get rid of this boredom.

As she reached the door, she could hear the guards chatting.

She also noticed the door wasn't exactly locked, and rolled her eyes hard enough to give herself a headache for a moment.

—So these idiots don't even know how to use a key.

The chatting stopped.

Did she say that aloud?

Oops…

—Back off from the door, Shadow Weaver!— a guard ordered from the other side.

—Or what!?— she barked back, smirking. —What will you lot do? Do you even *know* how to use a weapon!?— she then asked, cackling.

—Don't try us!— a second guard warned her.

But it was in vain.

Of *course* she would try them.

—I don't think you have the faintest idea how to use those lances. I bet they are accessories— she went on.

—Shut up!— one of the guards yelled, while the other muttered curses.

—Shut me up if you can- No, wait, you clearly can't— she laughed again.

And then the doors opened.

Meanwhile, back in Mystacor, Castaspella prepared to visit Shadow Weaver, Angella's prisoner, and her brother's former tutor.

It was so strange…

Oh, but she needed to talk to her!

She needed answers…

And she needed privacy; she couldn't speak freely with Angella there…

It was the only reason she was going to visit her before the sun rose.

Hence, as soon as she had everything tidied up for her to leave, she finally teleported directly to Bright Moon.

Appearing as close to the "prison" as possible, Castaspella could already hear the yelling of the guards.

Now what!?

The Head Sorceress rushed down the hall immediately, turned around the corner, and could see from there what all the ruckus was about.

—I dare you to say it again!— a guard was yelling.

—What's…— she uttered, but interrupted herself. Immediately running to intercede, Castaspella prepared a pair of shields on her hands and got herself between the guards and the figure on the ground. —What is the meaning of this!?

With a quick glance back, she could confirm that was, in fact, Shadow Weaver.

Maskless.

—She provoked us!— one of the guards replied.

—She got what she deserved— the other smirked.

—Enough!— Castaspella sentenced, standing more firmly and joining both shields into a bigger one. —I want you both to back off. *Now*.



—We have to…

—No— the sorceress interrupted. —No, you don't have to anymore.

—What!?— the guards let out in unison.

—Since you prove incompetent to keep a prisoner in check *and alive*, I'm talking her to Mystacor. You're dismissed.

—You can't do that. The Queen…

—*The Queen* will have to go to Mystacor if she wants to appeal the case. I'm talking her with me now.

Incidentally, the old woman remained on the ground, resting on one knee, clutching her left side where a stabbing wound kept oozing deep red blood.

Maybe she had gone too far provoking the guards…

But, meh, who cared?

She was actually more worried about how her mask fell where she was standing before, at the guards feet, which allowed them to see she was actually suffering.

What was the fun in showing she was in pain?

But she would have never guessed someone would come to her rescue, much less Castaspella.

Maybe… maybe she wasn't so sloppy when it came to defense…

Or maybe she had lost too much blood already and was losing her judgement.

In whatever case, by the time the Head Sorceress approached her to take her to Mystacor as she had said, Shadow Weaver's audition was already wanning, and she couldn't hear what she told her.

The old woman could only see Castaspella moving her lips to speak, increasingly desperate as she didn't answer, and little by little, her vision went black.

-Location: Mystacor-

Castaspella had teleported herself and Shadow Weaver directly back to Mystacor.

She had to move quickly. Shadow Weaver had already lost a lot of blood from the wound.

The Head Sorceress picked the older woman up as careful as possible. But instead of taking her to the palace's medical ward, Castaspella carried the woman directly to her private quarters.

And it was for two reasons. One, because the Head Sorceress didn't want to potentially risk Mystacor's own guards or healers doing something to make it worse. Two, because she wanted to tend to Shadow Weaver on her own.

-Castaspella's Room-

Castaspella took care to gently lay Shadow Weaver down on the bed.

The older woman had fallen completely unconscious due to the blood loss.

The Head Sorceress took a deep breath before lifting the side of Shadow Weaver's dress to see just how bad it was.

It was *bad*.

The wound was surely deep and it was still actively bleeding.

The Head Sorceress quickly went through a few steps in her head. Stop the bleeding, heal the worst of it, then clean and bandage it, and pray the older sorceress would eventually regain consciousness.

"Okay… I need to move quickly." She mutters to herself.

The Head Sorceress swiftly but carefully started to work. After stopping the bleeding, she cast a healing spell and used it to heal the worst of it.

After casting the spell, Castaspella left the room for a minute and rushed back with what she needed to clean and bandage the older woman's stab wound.

The younger woman sat on the edge of the bed and began cleaning the wound. Fortunately, Shadow Weaver was unconscious, which meant she wouldn't feel the pain at least. But it was still worrisome nonetheless.

Once she finished cleaning the wound, Castaspella started to wrap the bandaging around the older woman's lower waist, making sure to cover the wound enough.

Now that she was done tending to the wound, all she could do was sit and wait, praying that Shadow Weaver would eventually wake up.

It ended up taking a few hours but, finally, the older sorceress slowly began to stir, letting out a groan of pain before opening her eyes. The moment she shifted, she winced. She was about to clutch her side again, but she was stopped.

Castaspella had been sitting at her desk, quietly going over some stuff for potential changes in Mystacor. But the moment she heard that groan of pain, she quickly got up and rushed over. Seeing the older woman trying to clutch her side, she caught her hand by her wrist.

"No, no, don't do that," Castaspella calmly spoke. "You’re fine now. I healed the worst of it and then bandaged it. It just needs to heal now."

The older woman just groaned again, laying her head back down. She felt so weak from the blood loss earlier. And, to her, being seen this way, especially by someone like Castaspella, was pathetic. Normally, she wasn't one to show weakness or suffering that easily.

But deep down, she was somewhat grateful for having been saved at least.

After a beat of silence, Castaspella spoke again.

"You’re going to need to rest as much as you can. That stab wound will probably still take at least a couple of weeks to properly heal."

"Those… Stupid guards…" The older woman huffed out.

"To be fair… You did provoke them. But how they reacted, how they did this to you, was unjustified." The Head Sorceress sighed now.

At that, Shadow Weaver let out a quiet chuckle. While to her it was fun pissing off the guards, she had to-reluctantly-agree that she potentially shouldn't have gone that far at least.

Castaspella couldn't help but crack the faintest smile at the sound of the older sorceress's quiet chuckle.

"Well, you'll be staying in Mystacor instead. Since, clearly, those guards proved themselves to be idiots."

"But the Queen…-"

There, Castaspella cut her off.

"As I told those guards, *Queen Angella* will have to come to Mystacor if she wants to appeal the case. Because I'm keeping you here from now on."

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